

Texas WIC Health and Human Services Commission

Effective April 1, 2026

Policy No. CS:27.0(eWIC)

Enrollment of Transferring Participants

Purpose

To ensure transition of services and uninterrupted benefits for transferring participants for the entire duration of the current certification period.

Authority

7 CFR Part 246.7; State Policy

Policy

Participants transferring from another WIC local agency (LA) or from the WIC Overseas Program must be eligible to receive WIC benefits (or priority placement if a USDA and State agency-approved waiting list is in place) if they present valid proof of WIC identification from Texas or valid proof of current certification from another state or the WIC Overseas Program.

Definitions

Assign Texas WIC Card – The process of assigning a Texas WIC Card to an economic unit.

Cancel (i.e. deactivate) – The process in the MIS that permanently cancels the current card. When a new card is assigned, a PIN must be set.

Electronic Benefit Account (EBA) – the account where food benefits are being held for redemption.

Mosaic Interstate Transfer – a transfer between Texas and participating WIC programs using the Mosaic Information System (MIS) that includes Louisiana; New Mexico; Cherokee Nation; Pueblo of Isleta; and Indian Tribal Organizations (ITOs): Zuni, Santo Domingo, San Felipe, ACL (Acoma-Canoncito-Laguna), Five Sandoval, and Eight Northern.

Participant Transfer – A participant is transferred to another household within Texas due to a change in custody.

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In-state Transfer – A family and/or participant transfer occurring within Texas from one clinic to another.

Instream Migrant – A migrant farmworker or family member who comes into a clinic service area with the harvest stream and leaves the clinic service area, often mid-certification, for employment in the harvest of other crops or to return to her/his home base.

WIC Card Management Line – An interactive voice response system where clients can manage the Texas WIC Card (set/reset the PIN, cancel/replace the card), obtain food benefit balances, and speak to a customer service associate.

Verification of Certification (VOC) – Proof of participation in the WIC program that can be used to transfer participant(s) to and from another state. A VOC is not required for a Mosaic Interstate Transfer.

Procedures

I. In-state Transfer within Texas

- A. When a family requests a transfer from one clinic to another clinic, gaining clinic staff must transfer the family record to their clinic and schedule an appointment. Family transfers through myWIC will prompt the user to schedule an appointment or to contact the clinic to schedule the appointment.
- B. If the State Agency (SA) has a waiting list, place the participant(s) first on the list and enroll the participant(s) immediately according to [Policy CS:31.0](#).
- C. Request and view Proof of Identification for the Parent/Guardian prior to issuing benefits ([Policy CS:05.0](#)). Request and view Proof of Residency for the most current address, if available, ([Policy CS:06.0](#)) or accept a verbal declaration.
- D. Upload all food benefits to the economic unit's EBA for which the participant(s) is eligible.

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- E. If the participant has lost the Texas WIC Card refer to [Policy CS:26.0](#).
- II. Participant Transfer within Texas due to Change in Custody
 - A. The gaining clinic must determine which benefits the transferring participant will receive. Staff will initiate the Transfer process in the MIS.
 - B. Gaining clinic staff must request and view Proof of Identification ([Policy CS:05.0](#)) for the Parent/Guardian prior to issuing benefits.
 - C. Gaining staff must view Proof of Residency for the most current address, if available ([Policy CS:06.0](#)) or accept a verbal declaration.
 - D. The gaining clinic must upload eligible food benefits to the economic unit's EBA.
 - 1. If the participant is transferring to a new family within the MIS, staff must upload benefits to the gaining economic unit's EBA and assign a Texas WIC Card.
 - 2. If a participant is transferring to a family that has a Texas WIC Card, staff must upload benefits to the gaining economic unit's EBA.
 - 3. For foster children, see [Policy CS:11.0](#).
- III. Mosaic Interstate Transfers: When a family and/or participant(s) transfers between WIC programs that use Mosaic, staff may follow the procedures below in place of requesting a VOC.
 - A. Transfer the family and/or participant(s) using the Mosaic Interstate Transfer feature in the MIS.
 - B. In the MIS, document Proof of Identification ([Policy CS:05.0](#)) and Proof of Residency ([Policy CS:06.0](#)).
 - C. Staff must have the participant or parent/guardian/caretaker read, or have read to them, the Rights and Responsibilities, and parent/guardian/caretaker must electronically sign the document.

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- D. Assign/Replace a Texas WIC Card to the Family. The MIS will cancel (i.e., deactivate) the losing WIC Mosaic Card.
- E. If the Last Benefit End Date is unknown or if the Last Benefit End Date is for the current or a future month, upload benefits to the economic unit's EBA for the first day of the following month.

IV. Out of State and the WIC Overseas Program Transfers

- A. Acceptable documents for Out of State and WIC Overseas Program Transfers include the following with highest level of documentation listed in order:
 - 1. Transferring participant presents a hard copy or electronic image of the VOC.
 - 2. When a transferring participant does not present a VOC from another state or WIC overseas program, the local agency staff will contact the other state or Overseas Program to obtain the following information in order of importance:
 - i. VOC by electronic image or fax
 - ii. If the other state or Overseas Program cannot send the VOC by electronic image or fax, verbally obtain the following information and complete the VOC process in the MIS:
 - Name and date of birth of participant
 - Certification Start Date
 - Certification End Date
 - Last month benefits were received
 - Risk Codes
- B. Enroll the participant immediately once transfer documentation is obtained.
 - 1. In the MIS, document each participant as an Out-of-State VOC on the Participant page of the MIS.

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2. In the MIS, document Proof of Identification ([Policy CS:05.0](#)) and Proof of Residency ([Policy CS:06.0](#)). The VOC is valid until the end of the certification period shown on the VOC and must be accepted as proof of eligibility for program benefits. VOC transfer information must be entered into the MIS.
3. Documents obtained via electronic transmission are automatically saved in the MIS.
- C. If out-of-state and/or WIC Overseas Program proof of certification reflects a shorter certification period than Texas WIC Program certification periods, the LA must apply the Texas WIC Program's certification period.
- D. Enroll instream migrants and individuals transferring from Indian Tribal Organizations (ITOs) with valid WIC VOC. Instream migrants with an expired VOC must be enrolled if income was determined in the last 12 months.
- E. Assign/Replace a Texas WIC Card to the participant. Staff must inform the participant/parent/guardian to assign a PIN through myWIC or WIC Card Management Line prior to shopping at the grocery store.
 1. If the date when food benefits were last issued is unknown, contact the other state to verify issuance. If the participant does not have current benefits and is enrolled before the 16th of the month, full month benefits will be provided. If the participant is enrolled on or after the 16th of the month, a partial month benefits will be provided.
 2. If the participant has already redeemed all current month benefits, upload future months benefits to the economic unit's EBA.
 3. Upload any current unredeemed benefits and/or future months' benefits to the economic unit's EBA.

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4. Destroy the WIC Card or food instruments from the losing state.
- F. If the VOC does not reflect a specific nutrition risk condition or the participant was certified based on a nutrition risk condition not in use by Texas WIC, the MIS will assign risk condition 502, Transfer of Certification.
 1. A transfer cannot be refused because another state or WIC Overseas Program has nutrition risk criteria that are different from the criteria in Texas.
 2. It is not necessary to obtain additional information on nutrition risk conditions or clinical data. The nutrition risk determination by the originating state is sufficient to qualify the transferring participant for benefits through the end of the current certification period.
 3. Staff must have the participant or parent/guardian/caretaker read, or have read to her/him, the Rights and Responsibilities, and participant must sign the document electronically.
- V. Transfers leaving to another State or the WIC Overseas Program with Verification of Certification (VOC): When a participant informs the WIC clinic, they are leaving Texas to participate in another state WIC program follow this process:
 - A. Provide the participant a copy of their VOC to take with them to the gaining state. Staff must void any food benefits in the economic unit's EBA for the month(s) the participant will no longer reside in Texas.
 - B. Inform the family the Texas WIC card will not work in another state and to shop for WIC benefits before leaving Texas. Instruct the participant to give their Texas card to the new/gaining out of state or Overseas WIC clinic.
 - C. WIC participants issued VOCs when they transfer overseas must be instructed that:

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1. There is no guarantee that the WIC Overseas Program will be operational at the overseas site where they will be transferred.
2. By law only certain individuals are eligible for the WIC Overseas Program.
3. Issuance of a WIC VOC does not guarantee continued eligibility and participation in the WIC Overseas Program.
- D. A transferring participant may receive benefits at the new WIC Overseas Clinic, for the duration of the valid certification period documented on the VOC.

Guidelines

Information about the WIC Overseas Program may be accessed on the TRICARE website at tricare.mil/wic.